



JESUIT
Madurai Province



Footprints

Walking with the marginalized

Annual Magazine

2024-2025

Province Development Office
The Jesuit Madurai Province
Maduralaya, Dindigul-624 001

Our Projects



Empowering students through evening study centres.



Transforming the youth through technical education.



Caring for our common home through sustainable eco-projects.



Emancipating dalit and tribal children and women.



Training students to become agents of environmental protection.



Providing holistic healing from addiction.



Ensuring better facilities for the most deserving.

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Message from Fr. Provincial...!

Dear Friends,,

Greetings!

It gives me immense joy to learn that the Province Development Office is coming out with the Annual Magazine titled, *"Footprints: walking with the marginalized."* It is indeed an apt title as our mission has left behind indelible footprints in the lives of the poorest of the poor whom we serve. We serve in remote places in and through our social action centres and there are great impacts made in the lives of those whom we serve. Unfortunately, the impact of our mission remains unnoticed and rarely documented. The annual magazine of the Province Development Office captures those impactful interventions made in the lives of the people in and through our projects. We reach out to the children, women, youth, widows and those in most need who are not recognized by the mainstream society. In the recent years, we have been more ecologically conscious and some of our initiatives aim at protecting the environment. Our grassroots initiatives by our social action centres are directly connected to the struggles of the people and it is truly noteworthy that our men in these difficult places reach out to the most deserving with utmost sincerity and unwavering commitment to empower our people.

The annual magazine, *"Footprints"*, carries not only our initiatives and interventions but also a few insightful and inspiring articles written by Jesuits who are stalwarts in their respective fields. Hence, besides giving the readers an update on the implementation of the programs, the magazine will offer the readers more insights into various themes to ponder over. I acknowledge the hard work, commitment and generosity of all our friends who have partnered in our mission in their respective places for the upliftment of our people. I congratulate all our dear friends who have written these articles.

It is my sincere duty to acknowledge the enormous support of our dear benefactors from the Jesuit Mission offices in Europe and UK and other benefactors whose support and generosity make our mission more meaningful and fruitful. I request you all to whisper a prayer for all the kind and generous people who contribute for our mission and for all the people whom we serve in our mission. As you go through these pages of 'Footprints', may the inspiring and impactful words leave in your hearts indelible marks so as to make your footprints more meaningful in the lives of others.

I wish you all the best and assure you of my prayerful solidarity.

With prayerful good wishes,,



Fr. Thomas Amirtham, S.J.,
Provincial
Jesuit Madurai Province



Chapter 01

Empowering Dalit Children Through Education



Implementing Institution:

Amuthu Charitable Public Social Educational and Environmental Trust.

Objectives of the Project:



To ensure that all children continue their education without dropping out at any stage.



To improve and strengthen the learning skills and educational performance of every child.



To provide free evening tuition classes for children who are unable to pay and attend private classes.



To support economically disadvantaged families by assisting their children in pursuing higher education.



To help orphaned and single parent children continue their studies without any interruption.



To create awareness among students about higher education opportunities and guide them in selecting suitable courses.



To promote the physical, mental, and emotional wellbeing of children through holistic educational support.



To reduce educational inequality by providing equal learning opportunities for all children, regardless of their background.

Key Activities Carried Out in The Academic Year 2024–2025:

Amuthu Summer Camp:

The summer camp for the academic year 2025–2026 was organized at Thiruvannamalai. A total of 106 students and 10 staff members from AMUTHU centre took part in this enriching camp. It provided the children with a unique learning experience, not only academically but also in holistic skill development. Various training sessions were conducted, including drawing, dance, acting, painting, cooking, craft-making, colour-matching, hygiene and cleanliness practices, and Spoken English. These activities empowered the students with creative, practical, and communication skills, helping them discover their abilities in a joyful learning environment.

Children's Day:

The **CHILDREN'S DAY** celebration for the academic year 2025–2026 was held at the AMUTHU centre on 10.08.2025 with great success. A total of 250 students and evening class teachers from 60 villages participated in the event and made it memorable. The celebration was organized under the theme **"DISCIPLINE BRINGS ELEVATION."** The students enthusiastically showcased their talents through various events such as dance, drama, mime, poetry, essays, singing, and sports competitions. This remarkable celebration highlighted the discipline, confidence, and potential of the students of AMUTHU centre, making it a memorable and successful event.



Inauguration of Multi-Purpose Halls:

The AMUTHU centre proudly inaugurated **MULTI-PURPOSE HALLS**, fulfilling a long-standing need for children in the villages where the centre serves. Until now, the students had been learning by sitting on the floor in public spaces, often facing discomfort and weather challenges. Understanding this need, AMUTHU centre built halls to provide a safe, comfortable, and inspiring learning environment. This new facility ensures that children can study without interruption, especially during the rainy season, and offers a supportive atmosphere for their academic and personal growth. The construction of multi-purpose halls stands as a meaningful milestone in our mission to uplift rural students and create better learning opportunities for every child, marking a significant step forward in their journey towards a brighter future.



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Reducing educational inequality by providing equal learning opportunities for all children, regardless of their background.

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Quiz Competition:

The first round of the quiz competition for the academic year 2025–2026 was successfully conducted at the AMUTHU centre. Students from the evening learning centres across the villages where AMUTHU centre operates enthusiastically participated, showcasing their interest and talents. The main purpose of this competition is to strengthen children's general knowledge and academic excellence, helping them perform confidently in school and beyond. This initiative, which has been conducted consistently throughout the year, continues to inspire students to think critically, stay curious, and improve their learning skills. The event stood as a proud success, encouraging young minds to grow sharper, more confident, and better prepared for a bright future.



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Encouraging young minds to grow sharper, more confident, and better prepared for a bright future.

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Testimonies...

My name is Shobana and I am from Odaipatti. Since my school days, I have been a student at the evening study centre run by AMUTHU. After completing my schooling, with the support of AMUTHU, I pursued my undergraduate degree at MVM college in Dindigul and successfully completed it.

Following that, I continued my higher education in Tirunelveli. With the continued support of AMUTHU, I enrolled in the Government Law College, Tirunelveli, and completed my law degree as well. Throughout my school and college education, I received educational scholarships from AMUTHU, which greatly helped me in paying my academic fees and hostel expenses. AMUTHU played a crucial role in helping me complete my education without any interruption. Today, I have completed my law studies and I am currently undergoing training under a practicing lawyer. I am grateful to AMUTHU for being a significant part of my educational journey and success. I express my sincere thanks to the organization for their continuous support.

Ms. Shobana



Our Gratitude to...

The project is supported by the generosity of our friends from **Stiftung Jesuiten Weltweit**, Switzerland.

Chapter 02

Construction of Multi-Purpose Halls



Implementing Institution:

Amuthu Charitable Public Social Educational and Environmental Trust.

Short Description of the Project:

The ultimate objective of building multipurpose halls in AMUTHU social action centre was to increase students' participation and creating platform for the villagers for their social activities. As we have completed the project of constructing the halls, we are hopeful that these halls will benefit a large number of students and the poor villagers. More students can now have a roof over their heads and more particularly they can study in an amiable environment. The halls also have black board facilities which could help the students learn better from the tuition teachers.

With the new facilities...



Students' academic performance will be improved.



Gradually students' enrollment in the schools will go high.



Students will feel less distracted and enjoy more study environment.



The tuition teachers can make use of these halls for a long time to conduct lessons.



AMUTHU children would have these halls at their disposal for many years to come.



There will be good support from the people and this will help them celebrate their togetherness.

Goals Achieved by the Project:

The new multipurpose halls at present provide a space for students of those villages to gather for particularly evening tuition to complete their school given home works. This makes a sense of unity among them. The Jesuits in charge of the project ensured that all the works are carried out with utmost sincerity to give the best to our target people. We have handed over the halls with required facilities. On the day of the inauguration, the Province Treasurer and the PDD visited all the centres and were happy with the results of the project. They spoke to the people and they were very happy about the entire project.

“

The construction of multi-purpose halls stands as a meaningful milestone in our mission to uplift rural students and create better learning opportunities for every child.

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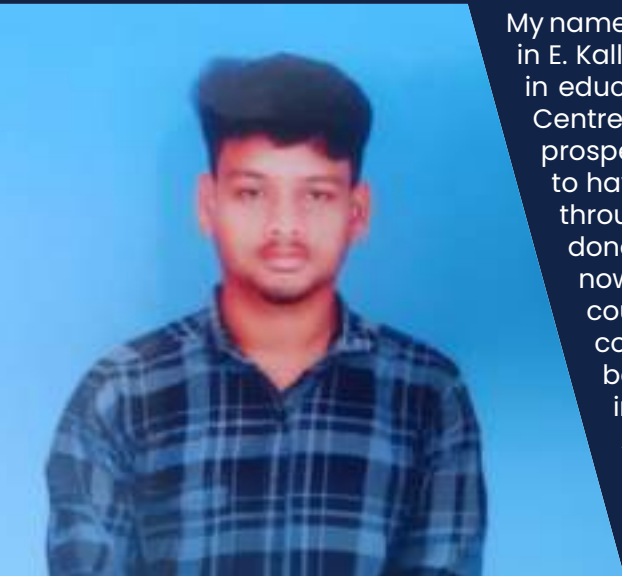
Testimonies...

My name is Meena, and I reside in Semmadai village. I have completed my B.A., in English Literature and am currently working as an evening study center staff member at Amuthu Centre. Our village is home to approximately 70 families, and all the children in our area are enrolled in government schools and colleges. For the past five years, Amuthu Centre has been providing educational support and services to these children, helping them in their studies and encouraging their academic growth.

Thanks to Amuthu Centre's efforts, our village has now received a new community hall. This facility has been constructed with the purpose of providing a dedicated, comfortable space for children and young people to sit and study. The construction of the community hall is a milestone for our village, and it will serve as a lasting asset for the educational development of our children. We are deeply grateful to Amuthu Centre and our donors from Nuremberg and Switzerland for this initiative, and we are confident that it will make a real difference in the academic achievements of the children in our community.

Ms. Meena





My name is Krithik Vijay, and I am currently pursuing my college studies. I live in E. Kallupatti, a village where Amuthu Centre has been actively involved in educational initiatives for the past ten years. Over the years, Amuthu Centre has made remarkable contributions to improve the educational prospects of the children in our village, and this year, we are fortunate to have received an even greater benefit – a new community hall built through the efforts of Amuthu Centre because of the generosity of our donors. This community hall is of immense value to us because, until now, there were no public spaces available in our village where children could sit and study, nor were there any areas where college students could gather to study. Thanks to Amuthu Centre, this building has been constructed, providing an ideal space for students to study in a quiet, comfortable, and conducive environment. We thank Amuthu Centre and our donors for their vision and commitment to improving the lives of people in our village, and we are confident that this initiative will continue to benefit generations to come.

Mr. Krithik Vijay

My name is Vasandha, and I have been working as a trainer at Amuthu Evening Study Center in Thippampatti village for the past ten years. Through Amuthu Centre, various educational and physical training programs have been offered to the children in our village. Thanks to Amuthu, the children in our area have been receiving educational assistance year after year, helping them in their studies and overall development.

This new community hall represents a significant step toward the development of our village. It is a symbol of progress, providing a modern and conducive environment for our children, students, and youth to study and prepare for various competitive exams. The youth in our village are now using the hall to prepare for government exams, which is a positive change. It has become a focal point for learning and community activities, benefiting everyone in our village.

We are very grateful for this initiative, as it will continue to benefit the children, students, and people of our village for many years to come. I am grateful to Jesuiten Weltweit, Nuremberg and our friends from Nandri Group, Switzerland for your loving support.



Mrs. Vasandha

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It is a symbol of progress, providing a modern and conducive environment for our children, students, and youth to study and prepare for various competitive exams.

”



Our Gratitude to...

The project was supported by the generosity of our friends from **Jesuitenweltweit, Nuremberg** and **Nandri-Help for South India**, Switzerland.

Chapter 03

Evening Study Centres – A platform for development



Dalit children in rural India particularly in the remote villages of Tamil Nadu have mostly limited access and that too, only to the Government schools or the SC/ST (Scheduled Caste/Scheduled Tribe) welfare-board schools. These schools have poor infrastructures, less number of teachers and lack of resources, etc. All these constraints significantly hinder the Children's ability to achieve their dreams. The participation of Children in co-curricular activities like sports, cultural events, etc., is an important element for developing their personality and self-confidence. However, the Dalit children in most of the schools are deprived of this important sphere of school life.

They miss suitable environment for studies not only in the schools but also in their own homes. Many of them are not able to devote quality time towards studies at their homes due to various limitations. The lack of physical facilities, unhealthy living conditions, congested homes and the emotional stress brought about by poverty keep the children distracted and occupied. Their parents are usually illiterate or poorly schooled and hence are not able to accompany them in their pursuit of knowledge. These are some of the painful factors that demotivate the Dalit children to stay at school and pursue their education.

Short Description of the Project:

Dr. Ambedkar Cultural Academy (DACA) has resolved to impart the basic education to Dalit children in south Tamil Nadu who are deprived of quality education and overall formation and to reduce their dropout rates. To achieve this task, DACA with the continued and generous support of *Stiftung Jesuiten Weltweit*, Zürich has established 100 Evening Study Centers (ESCs) across 6 districts of South Tamil Nadu (Madurai, Ramnad, Sivagangai, Tirunelveli, Tuticorin and Virudhunagar). These six districts are clubbed under four zones namely Madurai, Muthukulathur, Sattur and Tirunelveli.



Each Zone is coordinated effectively by a Zonal Coordinator. Nearly 3000 Dalit Children have been enrolled so far and are making use of the centres to sit, study and do their home-works. Each centre has a well-motivated animator to accompany the children in their studies.

“

Over the past 3 years, our children have planted nearly 7000 tree saplings across more than 80 villages.

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Objective of the project:

*The primary goal of these centres is to give quality primary education to rural Dalit children by providing them with suitable ambiance to study and develop various life skills and to motivate them to increase self-esteem to continue their studies and compete with other privileged children. To achieve this goal, DACA has formulated 3 dimensional developments namely **Education, Personality** and **Community**. All our plans and activities for ESCs are based on these three objectives.*

A few activities of the academic year 2024-2025:

In order to motivate the Children to excel academically, we do activities such as Science Exhibition, Quiz Contest, different awards for achievers, apart from their regular classes and trainings. In the area of Personality Development, we plan and execute various activities such as 'Thalirgalin Purachikathir', a Children's Magazine, Annual Days and observance of important days.

Our Children also play a significant role in Community Development by helping to eradicate plastics and clean common places in the villages. We are pleased to report that over the past 3 years, our children have planted nearly 7000 tree saplings across more than 80 villages. Now these trees are regularly watered and well-monitored by them. Our children have taken significant steps to improve the living conditions of people in their villages through Children's Parliament (CP).



Last year, the children representatives of our ESCs from 67 villages participated in the Grama Sabha meetings and presented petitions addressing various basic needs of their communities. We are proud to share that in 37 villages, the petitions of our children were accepted and fulfilled. These actions of our children have been widely appreciated among the people.

Every year DACA honors and motivates its best animators and coordinators with various awards. Last academic year alone, nearly 36 animators were awarded with the Dr. Ambedkar Awards for their outstanding performances in the community development programs. Additionally, two animators received the Founder Award and DACA Award for their noble contribution towards the holistic development of the children. Mr. Uthayamoorthy, the Coordinator of Muthukulathur Zone, was honored with the DACA SUDAR Award for his overall performance in the growth of the children and development of the villages.



Testimonies...

I am **S. KAVIYARASAN** from Anna Nagar Centre of Sathur zone, and I am currently doing 9th class. DACA's study centre has brought many positive changes in my life. I have been a student at DACA centre for the past three years. It has helped me complete my homework regularly. Whatever opportunities I miss in school, I get it in DACA centre. I am very proud to be a part of the DACA centre.

Mr. S. Kaviyarasan



I am **MS. DEVIBALA**, the Animator of Sellur Centre in Muthukulathur zone. I have been working as Animator here for the past 4 years. Initially, I focused solely on teaching textbook lessons to my children. However, through interactions with other Animators, I realized that my mission extends beyond just providing textbook knowledge, it also includes imparting life-oriented knowledge. I am always grateful to my fellow animators and our coordinator, who continually encourage me to do better. I wish to express my gratitude to our supporters and DACA for this invaluable opportunity in my life.

Ms. Devibala



Our Gratitude to...

The project is supported by the generosity of our friends from **Stiftung Jesuiten Weltweit**, Switzerland.

Chapter 04

Equipping the dining hall facilities



Implementing Institution:

Vidivelli Girls' Home, DACA, Madurai.

Short description of the project:

DR. AMBEDKAR CULTURAL ACADEMY (DACA) is an institution under Madurai Jesuit Downtrodden People Welfare Trust (Reg.No.126-IV/1994), established by the Jesuit Madurai Province. It is located near the Airport of Madurai. DACA has been actively working for the upliftment of the marginalized communities in Southern Tamil Nadu through its various initiatives. One of its key programmes is **VIDIVELLI GIRLS' HOME (VGH)**, which provides a supportive environment for nearly 200 Dalit girls each year, allowing them to pursue their formal education at no cost and promoting their overall development.

Objective of the project:

To improve the dining hall facilities for the girls in our home and improve their dining experience and overall well-being, we decided to provide dining tables and benches in our home. We firmly believed that this additional facility would enhance the academic performance of our girls and contribute to the development of their personalities. We submitted our request for dining table facilities to **BAY AREA TAMIL CATHOLIC FELLOWSHIP, USA.**



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Nearly 175 girls could comfortably sit on dining benches and enjoy their meals. For many of our girls, it is their first experience, sitting on benches and dining.

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THE APPROVAL OF THE PROJECT:

The project was generously approved by **Mr. John Eugene Edward**, the President of the Bay Area Tamil Catholic Fellowship, located at 5456 Midday Common, Fremont, CA 94555. The approval was granted on May 16, 2024 and immediately we began implementing the project of establishing dining facilities in our Home.

THE EXECUTION OF THE PROJECT:

The project to set up dining tables and benches was executed by St. Michael Industries in Madurai, Tamil Nadu. The materials used are 202 Light Weight Stainless Steel (SS). Each table measures 6x2.5 feet, while each bench measures 6x1.5 feet. Now, nearly 175 girls could comfortably sit on dining benches and enjoy their meals. For many of our girls, it is their first experience, sitting on benches and dining.

Testimonies...

SASIKALA A., Class XII: Earlier, when I saw people sitting on benches and enjoying their meals, I wished to have such experience in my life too. At the time, I realized it was a dream that felt out of reach for me. However, today in my home, I am very happy to sit on the dining benches and enjoy my meals. I feel wonderful, and my thoughts are filled with joy and gratitude. I am truly thankful to our kind benefactors in the Bay Area Tamil Catholic Fellowship.

Ms. Sasikala A



ANITHA J., Class VI: I used to sit on the floor to have my meals at home, but now I am very happy to sit on the dining benches. I love it so much! Since childhood, I have eagerly looked forward to sitting on dining benches while having my meals, and now my wish has been fulfilled. It was truly a joyful surprise for me. On behalf of my friends, I would like to express our sincere gratitude to our generous benefactors.

Ms. Anitha J



Our Gratitude to...

We are grateful to **Mr. John Eugene Edward** and all the dedicated members of the **BAY AREA TAMIL CATHOLIC FELLOWSHIP** for their generous support in providing dining facilities to our home.

Chapter 05

Vidivelli Girls' Home - A Temple of Empowerment

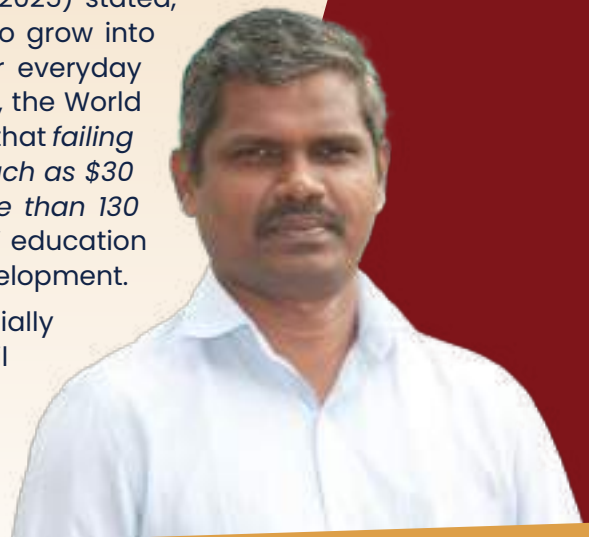
- Fr. Vargheesh Antony, S.J.,



Empowering Girl Children Through Education

In his address to delegates from the International Catholic Conference of Guiding (ICCG) in Rome in June 2015, Pope Francis (2013-2025) stated, "Education is the indispensable means for enabling girls to grow into active and responsible women, proud and happy in their everyday lives." On July 12, 2018, during the celebration of Malala Day, the World Bank emphasized the importance of girls' education, noting that *failing to let girls finish their education could cost the world as much as \$30 trillion lost in earnings and productivity annually, yet more than 130 million girls are out of school globally*. It is clear that girls' education significantly impacts both individual growth and societal development.

Knowing the importance of education in the lives of socially marginalized and economically poor communities in Tamil Nadu, Dr. Ambedkar Cultural Academy (DACA) with its motto 'Knowledge is Power', provides opportunities for Dalit girls through various programmes such as Vidivelli Girls' Home, Evening Study Centres and Summer Camps, etc. to pursue their dreams through education.



Vidivelli Girls' Home, supported continuously by *Jesuitenweltweit* in Nuremberg, Germany, has been providing an excellent milieu for Dalit girls to grow in every aspect of their lives for the past 28 years. Currently, 107 girls reside in the home and attend nearby schools and colleges.

The aim of our Home is *to enable the deprived and the downtrodden children to live a dignified life, to instil in them a hope of a bright future and to empower them work for a just social order*. To achieve this goal, our Home provides an excellent ambience to our girls, wherein they equip themselves with knowledge and life skills.

The unique feature about our home is that all the events and programs at our home are meticulously planned and executed by our girls, with guidance and consultation from staff and Jesuits. Our girls take on leading roles in organizing the events. Various departments operate within our home, including Education, Art and Culture, Health, Food and Kitchen, Garden, Games, Notice Board and etc. are led by our girls. By taking on these leadership roles and organizing events, our girls not only develop valuable leadership skills but also experience a significant boost in their self-esteem.

Periodically Special trainings and motivational talks in view of mental, physical, social, emotional and spiritual wellness of our children have been arranged for our girls. Apart from Educational and Cultural trainings, we also find that games are fantastic ways to teach Children discipline, self-regulation, life-values, etc.

Most of our girls had proved in different competitions both state and national levels that they are second to none. It is to be noted that Bhavatharani, a student of class 6th of our Home was selected by the Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu (SDAT) to represent our state in the national level Taekwondo tournament which was held in 2017 in Telangana state, wherein she won gold and brought laurels to our home and state.

We firmly believe in the words of Fr. Antony Raj, S.J., 'If Dalits only get an opportunity, they will reach the promised land where there is no bondage and servitude. Wherein they will be the fearless Children of modern society and will be able to assert themselves (*Interview in The Hindu on 27 July, 2011*). Today our Home has been regarded by the common people as a temple of enlightenment and empowerment of Dalit girls, supporting them in every aspect of their lives.



Testimonies...

M. SWETHA PRIYADHARSHINI, 12th Class: I have been able to consistently do well in my studies because of DACA and its dedicated efforts towards our education. It has been three years since I joined DACA. When I first came here, I was just an average or even below-average student. However, scoring 427 marks in my 10th public exam was a turning point that boosted my confidence. I chose the Computer Science group for my higher secondary studies. Now, in my 12th standard, I am aiming high and determined to score more than 550.

Ms. M. Swetha Priyadharshini



N. YUVASRI, College II Year: The DACA campus has given me great opportunity to excel in my studies. I am a first-generation learner, currently pursuing B.Sc. Physics. Earlier, I had a lot of fear and was not able to perform well in academics. But now, I am able to do well in my studies, thanks to the eco-friendly atmosphere of DACA campus and the educational support it provides—such as computers, a library, well-equipped classrooms, and dedicated staff. All these resources constantly motivate me to aim high and pursue my goal of securing a government job. I also receive financial support for my education, which is a big help.

Ms. N. Yuvasri

Chapter 06

Promoting and Advocating the Rights of Nature by widows and students



Implementing Institution:

Kalangarai Social Animation Centre, founded in 2005 at Nagapattinam, launched this new environmental project in the 20th year of its establishment. Its priority groups are widowed and single women, rural youth, and rural school-going children.

Objectives:

The main objective of this project is to promote environmental sustainability by involving school and college students in growing Tulasi plants, while simultaneously providing economic support to widows involved in producing seed balls, nurturing Tulasi plants, and making organic manure. This initiative not only encourages ecological awareness among youth but also empowers widows with meaningful livelihood opportunities. The project aims to combat global warming and climate change by encouraging the cultivation of Tulasi (Holy Basil) plants across four districts — mainly Nagapattinam and Mayiladuthurai, and secondarily Thanjavur and Thiruvarur districts in Tamil Nadu.

Launching of the project:

This three-year project was officially launched on 1st August 2024, marking the beginning of its first phase (August 2024 – July 2025). The project is scheduled for completion in July 2027.

Activities:

The activities include:



Providing skills to women to manufacture bio-manure and Tulasi seed balls and to nurture Tulasi saplings,



Raising awareness, inspiring action, and highlighting critical issues affecting the planet among students in schools and colleges situated in the Cauvery Delta districts and among women in self-help groups facilitated by Kalangarai, and



Giving training to women and the public interested in promoting bio-organic enterprises.



Training on bio-manure:

Training on manufacturing bio-manure was conducted for 20 women representing five self-help groups on 14th September 2024 in Nagapattinam district and for 30 members on 18th October 2024 in Mayiladuthurai district.



Training on Tulasi seed ball making

Training on Tulasi seed ball making was conducted for 25 women on 14th October in Nagapattinam and for 23 women on 18th October in Mayiladuthurai district. The women easily picked up the skill, and each person was able to make between 600 and 750 seed balls per day. One person could earn Rs. 350 per day.



Awareness programmes in schools and colleges

A total of 1,600 primary school children from 20 primary schools, 6,715 students from 14 middle and high schools, and 7,520 students from 9 higher secondary schools and 5 colleges took active part in this new mission.

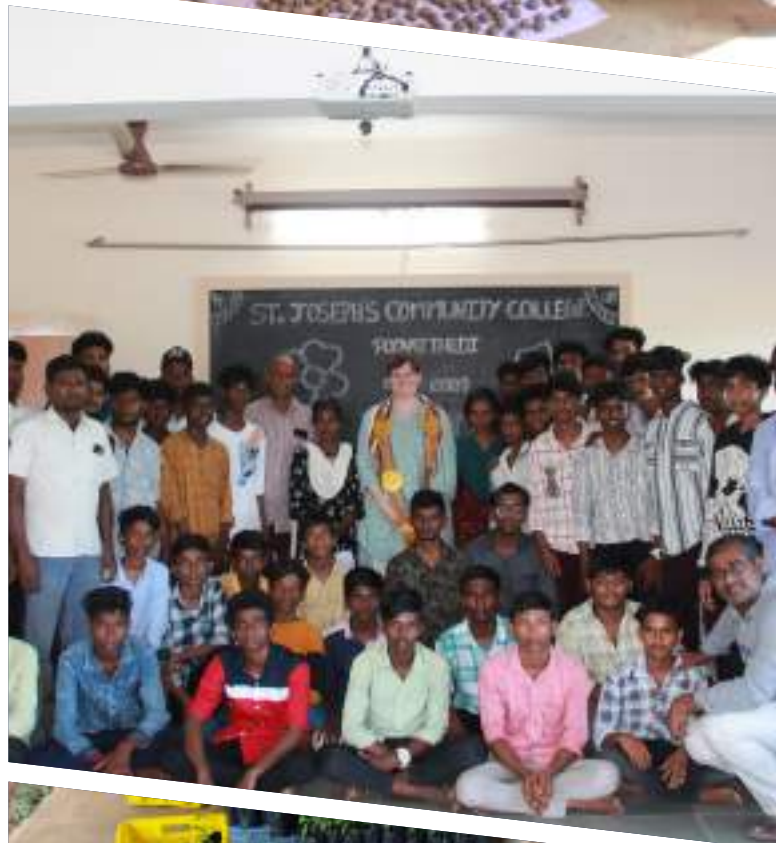


Commemorating International Days

We were also able to raise awareness on environmental issues among women who are members of Kalangarai-facilitated Self-Help Groups in Nagapattinam and Mayiladuthurai districts by commemorating international days such as:

- i) International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies 2024,
- ii) World Water Day 2025,
- iii) World Earth Day 2025,
- iv) Environment Day 2025.

These were celebrated by self-help group members facilitated by Kalangarai in five blocks. Around 250 women enthusiastically participated in each international celebration.





Trainings

A two-day training was organized in June 2025 for those interested in opening bio-organic shops. 20 women entrepreneurs participated in the training, and two self-help groups opened organic shops. Another three one-day trainings were conducted in three blocks for 20 women in each block who were interested in supplying organic food items like organic vegetables, millets, country chicken, country eggs, A2 milk, and bio-manure to organic shops in April 2025. Finally, two one-day trainings were conducted for the public on the importance of organic foods in July 2025. Around 50 persons, including men, actively participated in these trainings.



Impacts:



Schools

Following the awareness sessions, staff visited the participating schools for evaluation. Feedback was overwhelmingly positive. All the schools appreciated our endeavour. Many schools reported sowing *Tulasi* seeds on their campuses, and several students began growing *Tulasi* plants in their home gardens. Some students also developed the habit of consuming *Tulasi* leaves daily for their health benefits. The overall feedback was very encouraging.



Eco-clubs

While giving awareness sessions in schools, we requested the heads of the institution to establish eco-clubs in their respective institutions. We came to know that a few schools have already instituted eco-clubs and motivate students to do social service in villages and towns.





Additional income to widows

A total of 57 women were involved in Tulasi seed ball production, collectively earning Rs. 2 lakhs during the project period. This provided substantial additional income, contributing to improved financial stability for their families.



Seed ball making

During the period, a total of 400,000 seed balls were produced and distributed to 14,000 students across schools and colleges in the project area.



Organic shops

Two SHG members successfully opened organic shops:

- Mrs. V. Devi, from the Kurinji SHG, opened *Chandran Organic Shop* in Thinnunagiri on 16th July 2025, with support from Kalangarai.
- Mrs. Irudhaya Rosary opened her organic shop in her native village on 29th July 2025. Both women continue to receive produce supplies from fellow SHG members who cultivate organic vegetables.

Testimonies...

I am **Mrs. V. Devi**, wife of late Mr. Venkatesan, aged 39, and a widow belonging to the Kurinji Self-Help Group at Vedharajapuram. Three years ago, my husband passed away due to illness, leaving me with two sons and a daughter. After joining the Kurinji Widows SHG, with the guidance and encouragement of Kalangarai, I opened Chandran Organic Shop at Thinnunagiri on 16 July 2025. Kalangarai provided me with financial support through the Jesuiten Weltweit Project. These funds were used for renting and renovating the shop and purchasing stock at wholesale prices. Kalangarai also assisted six women from my SHG to cultivate organic vegetables to supply my shop. Through this initiative, both the women farmers and I benefit economically.

Mrs. V. Devi



Our Sincere Gratitude to...

The project is supported by the generosity of our friends from **Stiftung Jesuiten Weltweit**, Switzerland.

Chapter 07

Transforming the youth

– Fr. Kulandaisamy, S.J.,



Arising from the 2004 Tsunami relief efforts, Kalangarai, a Jesuit Social Action Centre in Madurai Province, under the *Nagai Jesuit Public Charitable Social and Educational Trust* in Nagapattinam district, Tamil Nadu, was established in 2005 to advocate for the rights and dignity of widows and single women through long-term social action. In India, widows are often viewed as symbols of misfortune, a perception deeply rooted in religious and superstitious beliefs that foster their dehumanisation. Kalangarai has consistently stood in solidarity with widows and single women, working toward their empowerment and the protection of their socio-political, economic, and cultural rights.

Responding to the challenges of widows and single women, Kalangarai was simultaneously relentless in empowering the youth. As a result of this, Kalangarai incorporated the new emergence from the academic discipline – the formation of community college, pioneered by Rev. Dr. S. Xavier Alphonse, S.J., in the year 1995 in India. The community college movement is committed to imparting skill training for the marginalized section of society. This alternative phenomenon sowed a firm confidence in socially vulnerable youths, who are not so vibrant in systematic academics but are interested in developing the necessary skills. The community college, aiming at gradual social change through building human resources in communities and forming responsible citizens through empowerment and capacity building, includes life-skills, work-skills, internship and job placement and also promotes self-employment through small-scale business development to alleviate poverty.

Kalangarai took this alternative education system since the focus of its mission is on the marginalised sections of society. Moreover, empowering the widows and making them self-sustainable extends beyond their personal growth; more significantly, educating their children and making them employable will improve their financial stability. Thus, in September 2005, Kalangarai formally started *St. Joseph's Community College*, offering courses in

- i) Electrical,
- ii) Desktop Publishing and
- iii) Air-conditioning and Refrigeration.

This community learning is not just confined to the classroom itself but spreads the learning beyond the classroom. Industry collaboration and Internships play a crucial role in technical education by incorporating practical training, partnerships with industries, and problem-based learning into the curriculum. Accordingly, our students are sent for internships to gain direct experience in different places, like Chennai, Coimbatore and Tirupur. Having completed their internships, most of the students have been employed by the same companies. In the course of time, many of them have advanced to positions such as supervisors and other higher roles. Over the past two decades, the college has succeeded in educating more than 1500 youths, who went astray from their studies due to various reasons, equipping them with technical skills and enhancing their employability.

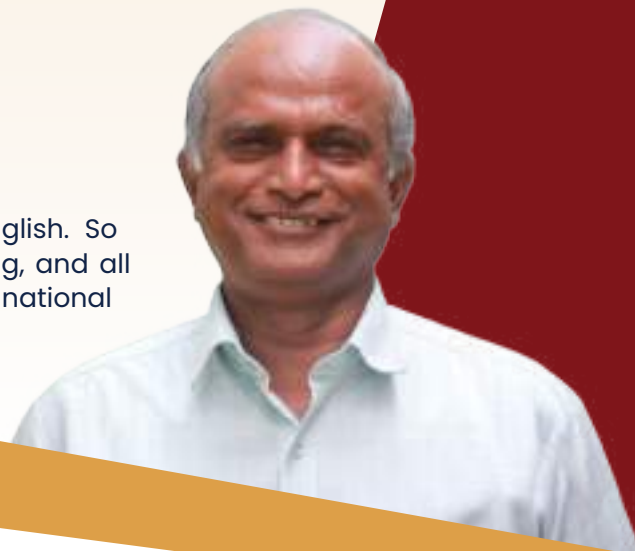
The following is the experience shared by one of the students who pursued her community learning. I am Dharshini from Agalangan, a remote village in Nagapattinam District. After completing my 10th standard, I joined the DTP course at *St. Joseph's Community College* in 2024. My mother, a widow and the sole breadwinner of my family, earns a modest daily wage which is not sufficient to provide my sister and me with three meals a day. I came to know about this college from a Kalangarai staff member who visits my village every month to hold a meeting for the widows' self-help group, facilitated by Kalangarai.

The college empowered me with technical knowledge while nurturing my skills and self-confidence. Today, I am working in a computer centre earning Rs. 8,000 every month. I am very grateful to St. Joseph's Community College for the education, support, and encouragement that I received.

Despite its long-standing commitment to equipping these young people, Kalangarai has nevertheless found a vacuum in its journey. India's demographic potential is enormous, with over 62% of its population in the working-age group, leading to rising unemployment rates, even among educated youth. Therefore, empowering a youth with certain skills alone will not necessarily open more opportunities in the job sectors.

In response to this reality, Kalangarai began a venture into the multi-skilled technician education, which serves young individuals to thrive in a competitive global economy. In June 2024, the Jesuit Madurai Province permitted Kalangarai to establish the **Multi-Skill Technician Centre** (MSTC) in the same Community College campus. This centre is designed to enhance students' technical competencies to meet international standards, thereby helping them secure employment abroad or in reputed companies across India. This centre gives a 45-day intensive residential program that includes training in:

- i) Refrigeration and Air-conditioning,
- ii) Electricals,
- iii) Welding,
- iv) Wiring,
- v) Plumbing,
- vi) Fire-fighting systems,
- vii) Kitchen management, and
- viii) Soft skills such as computer literacy and spoken English. So far, 40 youth have gone through this multi-skill training, and all are employed either in five-star hotels or in multi-national companies as technicians.



“ Testimonies...

Here is the testimony given by one of the trainees who pursued this intensive training for 45 days.

I am Leo Michael. After completing my Diploma in Electronics and Communication Engineering in 2017, I struggled with low-salaried work until I joined the two-month MST Centre course in Nagapattinam. The training helped me gain technical skills and basic English knowledge, and following the online interviews arranged by the MST Director, I was selected as a technician at the five-star Radisson Blu Hotel, Chennai. I am grateful to St. Joseph's MST Centre and its staff for their guidance and support.

The transformation of young people lies at the heart of Jesuit education and social action. Young minds, when guided and nurtured, possess the potential to become agents of change in their communities. By providing holistic education that combines knowledge, technical skills, and values, Kalangarai seeks to empower the youth to face the challenges of the modern world with confidence and compassion. Education not only equips them with employable skills but also shapes their moral and social consciousness, helping them to rise above ignorance, superstition, and injustice. True transformation occurs when young individuals realise their worth, take responsibility for their growth, and contribute meaningfully to building a just and inclusive society.

Chapter 08

Improved Infra-structural facilities for Trainees



Implementing Institution:

Madurai Jesuit Social Education Trust (IDEAS)

Objectives of the project:

- Improved infrastructural facilities for residential trainees.
- Improved work culture in the office set-up.

Key activities carried out in the academic year 2024-2025:

In the Training Block



13 single rooms converted with attached toilet facilities.



2 number two-bedded rooms converted with attached toilet facilities.



2 number three-bedded rooms converted with attached toilet facilities.



2 number four-bedded rooms converted with attached toilet facilities.



An unused hall has been converted into 5 number two-bedded rooms and 2 number three-bedded rooms with common enclosed toilets.



Improved discussion room with LCD facility.



Pest control treatment.



All beds with iron rods and mosquito nets.



Re-wiring and sanitation works.

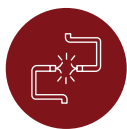
In the Administrative Block:



Flooring with tiles, renovation of toilets, repair of doors and windows, interior and exterior colour washing.



Change of water supply system and renovation of the water tank.



Re-wiring and sanitation works.

In the Jesuit quarters and common works:



A storeroom converted into a living room.



Laying of Paver block.



Main gate repair and sheet roof for the generator.



Additional CCTV cameras.



Improved drinking water facility.



Testimonies...

The training campus has been beautifully renovated and looks fresh and vibrant. All the buildings have been well-maintained and newly painted, giving the campus a very attractive and good appearance. Now the Training Centre offers a clean, peaceful, and eco-friendly environment, with safe, comfortable accommodation for trainees. It is commendable that biodegradable and non-biodegradable waste are collected and managed separately, and that clean drinking water and well-maintained dining facilities are available.

A Staff Of Sakthi Vidiyal, Our Partner Organisation



The renovated training rooms provide a conducive environment that helps participants feel dignified and respected. The improved digital infrastructure and comfortable seating arrangements support effective and engaging learning experiences. The presence of green spaces and a refreshing outside environment adds to the overall well-being and inspires a sense of peace and harmony. The renovated office and staff rooms enhance working conditions, creating a welcoming and professional space for coordination and support. Thanks for the opportunity to express my feelings of happiness in witnessing the renovation of IDEAS, which brings dignity, comfort, and renewed energy to our social work mission.

Sr. Roseline Mary, Fspm, Trainer And Mission Partner

Before the recent renovation, it used to be very difficult to sleep at night. The rooms were hot, and mosquitoes caused a lot of trouble, making it very uncomfortable. But now, the rooms are much improved – each has toilet facilities, mosquito nets, and good ventilation. The environment is cool and pleasant, allowing for peaceful and refreshing sleep. The trees and plants around the buildings also create a naturally cool and comfortable atmosphere. In the past, it used to be very difficult to walk between the Ambedkar building and the Periyar building, especially during the rainy season. Now, this has been improved with the construction of proper walkways, making it convenient to use in all seasons. IDEAS provides accommodation and food for participants and offers several quality transformative training programmes, shaping many political and community leaders. The renovation work would encourage and attract more young people to participate in various training programmes.

Mr. Akilan, All India Catholic University Federation



Our Sincere Gratitude to...

The project was supported by the generosity of our friends from **Stiftung Jesuiten Weltweit**, Switzerland.

Chapter 09

A ministry with a difference...!

– Fr. Francis Jayapathy, S.J.,

On 14th June, 2006, Fr. Devadoss Mudiappasamy, the then Provincial, had called me for a meeting with him. I had just returned to the province from three months of treatment of my own alcoholism. After a few pleasantries, he plunged straight into business. He gave me a twin mission: to help addicts to get sober and to grow in my own sobriety. Even now I don't know what prompted him to design this ministry. Was it just to help me consolidate my own recovery? Or the fact that the vast majority, 54.3% of the male population, the breadwinners, of the coastal communities of the state of Tamil Nadu, ravaged by the Tsunami of December 2004, were found to be clinically alcoholics? May be both considerations led him to his decision. He, I presume, recognised the ground reality. The province had assigned four teams of Jesuits to work among the villages ravaged by the Tsunami and had allocated a sizeable chunk of funds for their rehabilitation. Any rehabilitation plan must address the addiction problem to be effective. I happened to be in the right spot at the right time. He asked me to develop a plan and commissioned me to begin this ministry.

With my background in graduate studies in Social Anthropology, acquired degree of competence in Counselling Psychology, and theological studies, I developed a plan that begins by understanding and addressing the contemporary cultural concepts and social attitudes and use of alcohol and alcoholism. To this end, three seminars were held and the proceedings published. What emerged from these scholarly exercises was that the need to present to people a contemporary scientific understanding of alcoholism as a disease of mind, body and soul. They helped understanding addiction, its extent and its various dimensions: the medical, psychological, social and spiritual dimensions of its treatment.

Empirical evidence highlights significant prevalence rates of substance use disorders in the state of Tamil Nadu. A 2021 study found that the national average for male alcoholics is 29.2%, while only 1.2% of women consume alcohol. Alcohol consumption is higher in Tamil Nadu than the national average. One recent study by the National Institute of Mental Health and Neuro Sciences (NIMHANS) in households of rural, urban, town, and slum populations of 28,500 people found that the average monthly expenditure on alcohol of patients with alcohol addiction is more than their average monthly salary! To compound the problem, the last decade has shown significant rise of drugs among youth, students of schools and colleges. 10% of the drugs entering Tamil Nadu, goes directly to schools and college students. Jesuit colleges – our province has four colleges and eight schools – are no exception.

Dominant High culture of Tamil Nadu, both religious and social, unequivocally condemns alcohol and drugs usage. It is moralistic. The Jesuit Ministry to Alcohol and Drug Dependents (JMAADD), from its early days, recognized this challenge and began to spend considerable effort and resources in presenting the problem in the perspective of health of the whole person. It adopted the idea that alcoholism and drug dependence is a disease and that it is treatable. The disease is physiological, mental, and relational. Above all it is a spiritual sickness. This became its core message in its programmes of awareness among the general public and youth in particular. This understanding guides our month-long treatment programmes.

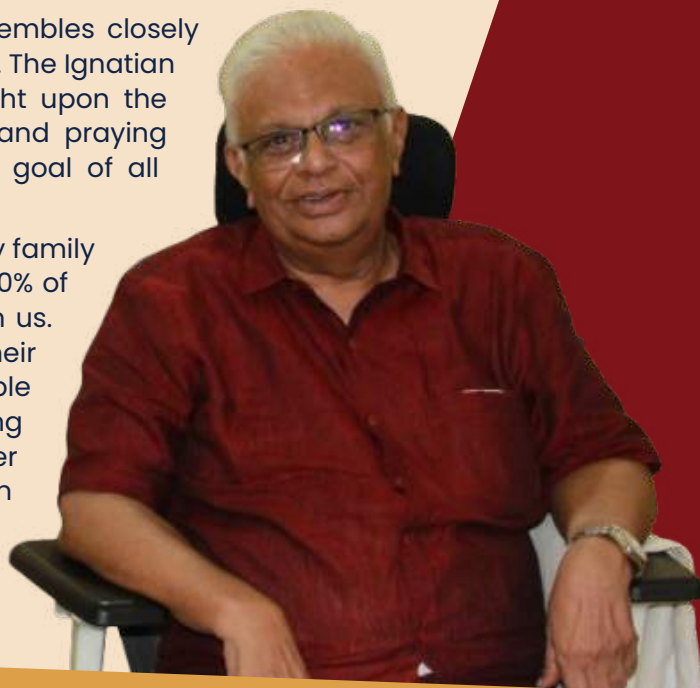
What began in 2006, now has grown as a full-fledged ministry of the Jesuit Madurai Province. Over the years, two teams are working: one in Nagercoil, a town in the southernmost district of Tamil Nadu and another in Tiruchi, an ancient city in the heart of the state.

In the early days, a Jesuit province beginning a health service felt quite foreign to the Jesuit charism. However, within a few months, perceptions began to change. A senior Jesuit came to hear confessions of alcoholics at a JMAADD treatment programme. He had this to say: "If this programme brings people to such level of spirituality, my God, this is what we should be doing. This is truly a Jesuit ministry". A college dropout who is struggling with drug addiction responded to the question: what have you learned in your time with us? Without hesitation he replied: 'I have learned to pray!'.

To my happy surprise, I learned that the problem of addiction has been in the mind of Venerable Pedro Arrupe. On 22nd May, 1982, Fr. Pittau read out the 'final testament' of Pedro Arrupe: "To my spiritual sons... I bequeath the young manipulated by drugs". [cf. p. 310 & 312, 2000, George Bishop, Pedro Arrupe SJ, GSP, Ahmedabad]. It is in honour of this gift of Pedro that the Tiruchi centre is named Arrupe Health Enclave for Alcohol and Drug Deaddiction (AHEAD).

The 12-steps-programme that we have adopted resembles closely the Spiritual Exercises of our Founder Ignatius of Loyola. The Ignatian principle of "*tantum quantum*" throws a spiritual light upon the phenomenon of addiction itself. Seeking God's will and praying for the strength to carry out His will should be the goal of all human endeavour.

In a meeting of our patients, one witnessed: "If I and my family are alive today, it is because of the Jesuit Ministry!" 60% of our patients recover and continue to be in touch with us. They repair their rundown houses, dress better and their children do better in their studies. One telling sample will be of a family: the eldest is successfully completing his graduate studies in data science and the younger one is an A level student in a graduate programme on Artificial Intelligence! We have quite a collection of such success stories! It is indeed a Jesuit ministry—with a difference!



Our Gratitude to...

The project was supported by the generosity of our friends from **Stiftung Jesuiten Weltweit**, Switzerland and **Jesuit Missions-UK**, London.

Chapter 10

Training Students in Organic Farming and Sustainable Agriculture and Promoting Agro-Tourism



Implementing Institution:

The Society of St. Francis Xavier, St. Xavier's College, Palayamkottai.

Objectives of the project



To set up a museum of agriculture to encourage natural farming and agro-tourism.



To give awareness on organic farming and recent eco-friendly pest control technologies to students and parents using audio-visual aids and practical demonstrations.



To give hands-on training and demonstration to the students on preparation of botanical pesticides and enriched Vermicompost.



To encourage the students to produce and sell the organic products raised by them in the field allotted to them.



To help students raise medicinal plants, green herbs, vegetables and fruits organically.



To help students to live and experience first-hand dealing with household animals.

Key activities carried out :

The project focused on providing **hands-on training** to students to understand and practice of **organic farming techniques** at the college farm located in Irudayakulam, Tirunelveli District. Through this program, students gained practical experience in cultivating organically grown herbs, medicinal plants, vegetables, and fruits, as well as in managing cattle and poultry. A total of **ten hectares of farmland**, named "**Xavier Solai**" has been allocated for this initiative.

Several key activities were undertaken. The land was divided into around **20 distinct blocks** based on soil characteristics for plant cultivation and animal husbandry. The blocks include:

- **Xerophyte Garden**
- **Podhigai Garden** (Kaani Tribe – Medicinal Plants)
- **Fruit Garden**
- **Medicinal Tree Garden**
- **Herbal Garden**
- **Traditional Paddy Field**
- **Vegetable Garden**
- **Dragon Fruit and Guava Garden**
- **Pulses and Cereals Field**
- **Coconut Grove**
- **Timber Wood Plantation**



Existing **cashew and mango orchards** were maintained, and **freshwater fish culture** was introduced in newly constructed ponds. An additional pond was created to store water for fish culture and agricultural irrigation.

For organic farming purposes, various **bio-fertilizers and bio-pesticides** were prepared on-site. These include **vermicompost, fish amino acid, ten-leaf extract, palm fruit extract, panchagavya, jeevamirtham, kana jeevamirtham, agni astharam, and azolla culture**. A **camphor-based mixture** was freshly prepared.

More than 3,000 students from local schools participated in a project focused on organic farming, gaining valuable insights during their visit to Xavier Solai. Numerous farmers also attended, where they were educated on the principles of organic farming and the identification of various insects. More than 800 Siddha doctors and traditional practitioners benefited from the awareness programme.



“

More than 3,000 students from local schools participated in a project focused on organic farming, gaining valuable insights during their visit to Xavier Solai

”



Testimonies...

It is well planned and established garden with plants of different varieties. It is much appreciated. It is good for students and nature.

Dr. Ravichandran (V. Senior Preservation Assistant, Botanical Survey Of India, Coimbatore)

This is an excellent spot for protecting our nature. It is an innovative initiative. We will visit again. Xavier Solai is very informative for the teachers of Cambridge school; We really grateful for this park.

Mr. F. Arockiasamy, (Vickramasingapuram)

Today is a very special day for all of us students and faculty. We saw very rare and endangered species in Xavier Solai.

Dr. V. Irudayaraj, (Department Of Botany, St. Xavier's College)

It is very useful for all the learners and it's an important livelihood opportunity. Therefore, all those interested should continue to attend in future.

Ms. S. Esther

This is a very good initiative. I am sure in the future it will be noted as a centre of excellence.

Fr. L. John Peter Arulanandam. (St. Joseph's College, Tiruchirappalli)



Our Gratitude to...

The project was supported by the generosity of our friends from **Jesuiten Weltweit**, Nuremberg.

Chapter 11

Eco-Consciousness: Need of the hour

– Fr. Ignacimuthu, S. J.,

Eco-consciousness is the awareness of environmental matters and the interconnectedness of human actions with the natural world, leading us to a feeling of responsibility, respect and concern to do something proactively to safeguard the environment.

This is linked to our understanding of the environmental impact of our actions, a strong desire to care for the good of the environment, and taking steps to act on those issues which harm the environment with a view to promote sustainability and protect the environment.

Eco-consciousness is founded on the realization of the intrinsic worth of the environment with all its living beings and non-living things. It makes us respect, appreciate, protect and regenerate the environment. It evokes a love for nature. It enables us to use the gifts of nature judiciously by avoiding pollution, waste and destruction.

Eco-consciousness forbids us to abuse natural and biological resources. It motivates us to work for clean and healthy environment. It emerges from the realization that the environment is the heart of our intellectual, moral, aesthetic, physiological, psychological and spiritual wellness.

People living today not only have to consider our own well-being, but also the well-being of our future generations. Our impact on the environment is strongly affected by how we view our earthly home.

Eco-consciousness prompts us to re-discover our roots, our interconnectedness and our independence in the cosmos. It re-awakens our conscience in relation to our duties and responsibilities to all that exists in the environment.

Eco-consciousness is very important in today's context as the effect of environmental deterioration is being felt all over the world through climate change, global warming, natural disaster, loss of biodiversity, pollution, deforestation etc. We can no longer be mere onlookers. It brings about a shift in paradigm which generates awareness and guides us to act.

Eco-consciousness drives us to realize that all these years, the environment has contributed to the well-being of humans not only by providing food, shelter, medicine etc., but also by elevating human spirits with ecstatic beauty, grandeur, awe and wonder; however, due to human greed, in recent years, we have abused the environment and contributed to its deterioration through various harmful activities. Hence, eco-consciousness calls us for responsibility. It leads an attitudinal and structural change. It motivates us to strive towards sustainability.

We are at an important moment of human history. We stand at a very critical and challenging time in relation to the environment. We have to make the right choices in order to preserve the human race from destruction. This can be achieved only through eco-consciousness.

In order to promote eco-consciousness among students, farmers and the public we have carried out various activities. A summary of our activities is presented here.

1. Through one project, we promoted organic farming practices to enhance livelihood of farmers in Tirunelveli district. This project was supported by Jesuiten Weltweit, Germany.

Agriculture is the means of sustenance in Tirunelveli district. Conventional farming viz. use of synthetic fertilizers, pesticides and weedicides has adverse impacts on health and biodiversity of this area. We worked to enhance the sustainable rural livelihood and job security among the farmers.

We conducted basic awareness camps. Nearly 5,000 farmers from 55 villages were selected. They were given training on the following topics of sustainable agriculture processes: importance of microbes for soil fertilization and ways to maintain soil health like crop rotation, inter-cropping, multi-cropping, mulching, use of vermicompost and farmyard manure; use of natural plant growth regulators; use of

botanical pesticides like PONNEEM; biological methods to control pests and wild animals. Hands on training was given to the farmers to prepare organic products for their own use.

2. Through another project we developed Xavier Solai (agro, eco, biodiversity park) to promote Agro-Tourism for the benefit of students, farmers and the public. This project was supported by Jesuiten Weltweit, Switzerland.

The project was established in the farm located in Irudayakulam, Tirunelveli District in 10 hectares of land named as XAVIER SOLAI. An artificial fish pond has been established, and a greenhouse has been constructed to nurture saplings. Various gardens have been developed, including those for xerophyte plants, medicinal trees, a fruit tree garden, a medicinal herb garden, and plots for vegetables, pulses, and cereals, all of which are being carefully maintained organically. A timber garden has also been established. All plants have name boards. A walking pathway has been created for viewing whole Xavier Solai and aquatic birds.

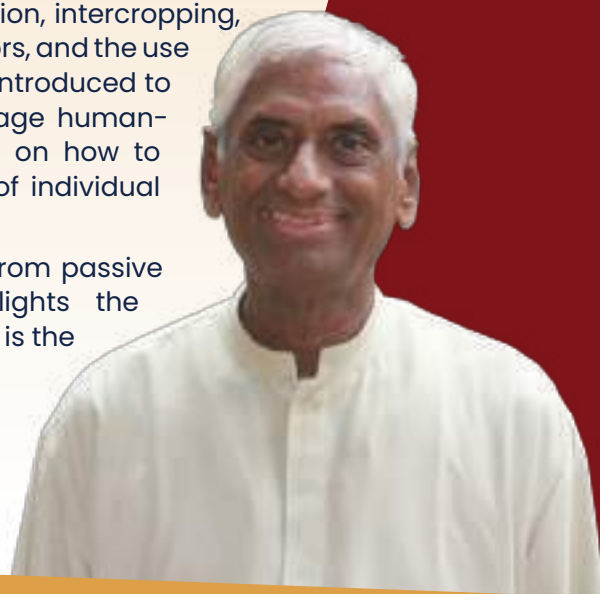
In the realm of organic farming, essential bio-fertilizers and bio-pesticides have been developed to support plantation efforts. The ongoing processes include the preparation of vermicompost, the formulation of Ponneem, fish amino acids, and the cultivation of *Azospirillum*. We organized awareness initiatives aimed at educating numerous school students, farmers and the public on the principles of organic farming and sustainable agricultural practices. Visits from Siddha physicians, school students, farmers, and researchers to Xavier Solai further enriched this initiative. To enhance the promotion of organic farming, informative pamphlets were distributed to students, farmers and the public. So far more than 10,000 students, farmers and the public have benefited from this.

3. Through another project, we trained students to be agents of environmental protection and organic farming. This project was supported by Jesuiten Weltweit, Germany.

We fostered environmental awareness among students in local schools on ecological literacy and sustainable practices. Nearly 10,000 students across various schools were given training. The awareness program covered a comprehensive range of topics central to understanding environmental systems. These included the interdependence of plants, animals, and humans; the roles of consumers and decomposers; the importance of natural resources and diverse habitats; fossil formation; the impact of pollution and deforestation; and the critical role of biodiversity.

Additionally, the sessions explored soil health, the significance of microbes, and sustainable agricultural practices such as crop rotation, intercropping, mulching, vermicomposting, natural plant growth regulators, and the use of botanical pesticides like PONNEEM. Students were also introduced to biological pest control methods and strategies to manage human-wildlife conflict. Furthermore, the students were guided on how to respond to environmental threats and the importance of individual and collective action in protecting the planet.

The transformation of students, farmers and the public from passive learners to proactive environmental stewards highlights the program's success in fostering eco-consciousness, which is the need of the hour.



Chapter 12

Developing an Eco-sanctuary



Implementing Institution:

The Sacred Heart College, Shembaganur, Kodaikanal

Objectives of the project:



Developing an Eco-sanctuary for the ecological education of the school / college students and the general public in order to create awareness on environmental protection and preservation towards the care for our common home.



Bringing out a noticeable change of the existing place into an eco-sanctuary.



Having a well-equipped eco-sanctuary ready and the trees, plants, birds will be protected and preserved better.



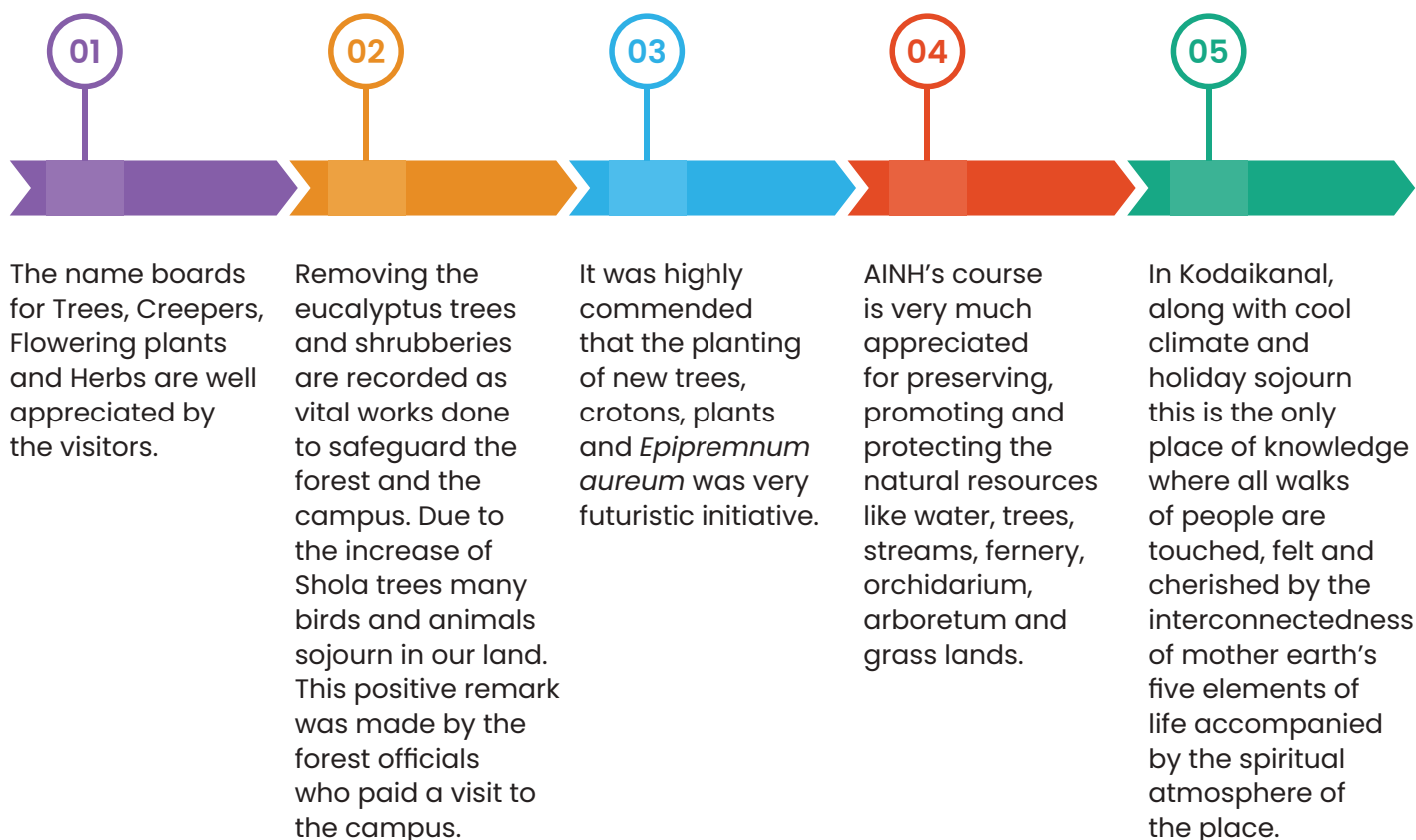
The ecological education and awareness programmes will make a huge transformation in the minds and hearts of those who visit us.



Key activities carried out in the academic year 2024-2025

- Regular workshop and programmes are organized for inculcating in the hearts and minds of the students and general public the importance of caring for our common home by conducting environmental awareness programs in collaboration with the ANGLADE Institute of Natural History, which has been serving the student community for many decades.
 - Pathway road formation is done by mending and repairing the dilapidated roads for 2 k.m. along with alley landscaping carried out with three different experts' team.
 - Removing bush (a stunted, low-branched tree that typically grows in dry or poor-quality soil, giving it a dense, bushy, or scraggly appearance) was done for more than two months.
 - The natural water source was cleared to flow into the entire path way. Basic work for streamlining the Living Herbarium was carried out with pipelines and water taps or sprinklers. Proper drainage system was built to avoid wasting water.
- Anglade Institute of Natural History (AINH)** prepared Steel Board for Hundreds of trees, Creepers, Flowering plants, Herbs, etc. which require a name plate with botanical names, real name in English and Tamil and the uses of the species to educate the visitors.
 - Established Sheds to create a controlled climate for growing plants.
 - Fencing work is started with Iron post cutting and bending according the places.

Outcome of the ongoing project



Our Sincere Gratitude to...

The project was supported by the generosity of our friends from **Jesuiten Weltweit**, Switzerland.

Chapter 13

Empowering the Children & Women of Dalit and Tribal communities of Kodai Hills through education, awareness building and capacitation



Implementing Institution:

People's Education for Action in Kodaikanal (PEAK) Trust, Sacred Heart College, Shembaganur, Kodaikanal.

Short Description of the project:

PEAK has served the Dalit and Tribal communities of the Kodaikanal Hills for over three decades, working for their social, educational, and economic empowerment. Many children and women in these communities face challenges that limit their growth. To address this, PEAK focuses on education, awareness and capacity building.

Through its initiatives, the organization promotes education, savings, self-confidence, and leadership among children and women. The project "Empowering the Children & Women of Dalit and Tribal communities of Kodai Hills through Education, Awareness Building, and Capacitation" aims to develop their potential and strengthen their role in society. This report presents the main activities, outcomes, and challenges of 2024–2025.

Objective of the project



Ensuring that all children of the target villages pursue their studies.



Monitoring drop-out children and making efforts to send them back to school.



Facilitating the study of children – clearing doubts about lessons, helping them do their homework, and helping them to understand basic concepts.



Unearthing the hidden talents of children – writing, speaking, drawing, and leadership qualities.



Building constant awareness on cleanliness.



Capacitation and organizing Tribal & Dalit Women.



Building awareness on health and hygiene, legal rights, and organizing women as a movement.

Key activities carried out in the academic year 2024-2025



Evening Coaching Centres (ECC) in Kodaikanal Villages

In the villages of Kodaikanal, many Dalit and Tribal families live in small houses. The children do not have a supportive environment to study at home, and their parents often lack an academic background to guide them in their studies. To address this, PEAK established Evening Coaching Centres for the children studying in the local village schools.

At present, there are 15 evening coaching centres. On weekdays, the classes run for one and a half hours in the evening. Most classes are held in community halls, while in villages without community halls, rented houses are used.

In these centres, teachers provide listening, reading, writing, and speaking practice in both Tamil and English. They help students complete homework and review lessons taught in schools. Teachers also guide them in learning general knowledge, action songs, and social awareness songs. In addition, the play-way method is used to teach basic mathematics and vocabulary.

Other Activities in Each Village

- Children's Parliament.
- Monthly Meetings with ECC Staff.
- Training Sessions for ECC Teachers.
- Magazine – Sigaram Thodu.
- Children's Day Celebration.
- Dr. Ambedkar's Death Anniversary.
- Human Rights Day.
- Pongal Celebration.
- Annual Day and Dr. Ambedkar's Birth Anniversary Celebrations.



Challenges

- Some students are irregular in attending the classes and show a lack of interest in studying after school.
- Parents often do not understand the value of education and fail to encourage their children to attend both school and evening coaching centres regularly.
- Some teachers are not able to attend monthly meetings and training sessions held at Shembaganur.
- Due to the Tamil Nadu government's 'Illam Thedi Kalvi' scheme, which established new tuition centres in the villages, some children have shifted to those centres.



Self Help Groups for Women

Women today stand as equals to men in society. They have overcome many barriers and entered every field; space, research, science, technology, policing, politics, aviation, and transportation. Their achievements are on par with men, bringing pride to women everywhere.

For the past 35 years, the PEAK organization has been carrying out various initiatives for women's development, including:

1. Encouraging small savings among women,
2. Celebrating International Women's Day every year,
3. Forming self-help groups,
4. Conducting leadership training, and
5. Helping women start their own businesses.

Recognizing that savings play a vital role in women's financial independence, PEAK began promoting the habit of saving. Over time, the organization realized that real empowerment comes through unity and collaboration. As a result, 28 women's groups have been formed; 23 in the upper hill region and 5 in the lower hill region. These groups have opened bank accounts and have been saving regularly for two years. In total, there are 350 women in these groups, while three additional villages have around 120 women participating in savings groups.



PEAK also provides interest-free loans to help members to start small businesses. So far, 135 women have received loans of Rs. 15,000 or Rs. 20,000 each. This support has enabled them to lease agricultural land, buy livestock such as goats, cows, and horses, and purchase seeds and fertilizers to cultivate crops like peas, garlic, and potatoes. Some women have even opened small restaurants, grocery stores and petty shops increasing their family income. These opportunities have helped women become financially independent, marking not only their personal growth but also the success of PEAK's empowerment efforts. This progress stands as a powerful example of women's empowerment. It is no exaggeration to say that the PEAK organization has been a guiding force in supporting women's growth and development.

Challenges

- Some women who receive loans fail to repay them, making it difficult to extend loans to others, since the programme works on a revolving fund system.
- Many women limit themselves to saving and do not actively participate in development programmes aimed at building confidence and social identity.
- In some cases, the savings amount is very small compared to the loan requested, raising doubts about their repayment capacity.

Outcome of the project

This year 201 students (81 students in Inigo Siruvar Illam and 62 students in Inigo Boys' home and 30 girl students in Grihini and 28 students in other hostels) and 247 students in Evening Coaching Centres are supported by PEAK Trust.

25 Self-Help Groups (SHG) are formed and 300 women are organized under SHG schemes.

Conclusion

The efforts of PEAK during the reporting period have led to meaningful progress in both child and women empowerment. The evening coaching centres have supported hundreds of children in continuing their education, while the self-help groups have helped women gain economic confidence and leadership experience. Infrastructure improvements such as the Inigo Dining Hall have further enhanced the living and learning environment for children.

Although challenges like irregular student attendance, loan repayment issues, and limited participation from women remain, PEAK continues to address these issues through sustained awareness, motivation, and training. The organization remains committed to its mission of empowering the marginalized communities through education and collective action, paving the way for a more just, equitable, and self-reliant society in the Kodaikanal Hills.



Our Sincere Gratitude to...

We express our sincere gratitude to the Jesuit Conference of South Asia and the Conference Development Office for supporting this project.

Chapter 14

Renovation of INIGO Boys' Home in Kodaikanal



Implementing Institution:

PEAK Trust, Sacred Heart College, Shembaganur, Kodaikanal, Tamil Nadu, India

Short Description of the project:

The **INIGO Boys' Home** has been run for the past 27 years and so far, around 1000 boys have completed their schooling using the home facilities. The director of PEAK is responsible for the running of the home. Under him, there is a Jesuit Regent who directly supervises all the activities of the hostel. Under him, there are two full-time wardens and one cook who stay with the boys all through. All these years the boys have managed to have their meals in the tin-sheeted shed, having a small kitchen and a smaller number of toilet facilities. In times of rainy season, needless to say, the hardships of the inmates are really heavy. Kodaikanal being a hilly region, gets incessant rains quite often.

Objectives of the project:

The project titled, "Renovation of INIGO Boys' Home in Kodaikanal" was solely designed to serve the students in our care by providing them with decent dining hall and toilet facilities. The main goal of the project is to enhance the infrastructural facilities of **Children's Hostel** i.e., a) construction of a new dining hall, b) construction of a new kitchen and a store room adjacent to the dining hall, c) construction of two retaining walls to protect the building, and d) construction of a few more additional decent toilets.

This project will surely benefit the poor Tribal and Dalit students in our hostels who are empowered through education. They will have enhanced infrastructural facilities and will have a better ambience to study in our hostels.

Goals Achieved by the Project:

As part of the renovation project, the new dining hall has been constructed with all the facilities required for the use of the children. As per the goal of the project, infrastructural facilities have been improved and we are grateful to Father General and for the support of FACSI for the successful completion of the project. Now, the dining hall and other additional infrastructural facilities are ready. The completed project will enhance the living standard of the tribal children who are in our care. It will give them decent space and facilities for having food and for the access to other basic necessities.

With the generous support received through FACSI, a large modern dining hall has now been built where 120 children can sit and have their meals at the same time. The new dining space, equipped with all modern amenities, has brought great joy and comfort to the children. It stands as an important contribution to their overall development. This new dining hall will undoubtedly play a significant role in supporting the education and well-being of the children for many years to come.



Our Sincere Gratitude to...

We express our sincere gratitude to Father General for supporting this project through FACSI.

Chapter 15

Shaping the present for the future of the tribal communities in Kodai hills..!

– Fr. Anthony James, S.J.

Among the serene hills of Kodaikanal in Dindigul district live two ancient tribes — the *Paliyar* and the *Puliyar*. For generations, these communities have lived in isolation, relying on nature for sustenance. Their livelihoods depend on collecting pepper, honey, coffee, and medicinal herbs from the forests, selling them in small quantities, and engaging in subsistence labour. With no access to land ownership, proper housing, or formal education, they faced a life marked by daily survival and dependency, devoid of long-term security or development.

Recognizing their plight, the PEAK organization (People's Education and Action in Kodaikanal) stepped forward to bring transformation to these communities. Through persistent efforts, PEAK began creating awareness among the tribes about their social, economic, and health conditions. The organization helped them to realize their fundamental needs, their rights, and the opportunities available to them through government welfare schemes.

Promoting Education and Awareness

Education became the cornerstone of PEAK's mission. Understanding that illiteracy made the tribal people vulnerable to exploitation, PEAK established hostels for the children and extended assistance for higher education. Evening coaching centres were introduced within villages to ensure continuous learning. This educational empowerment gradually enabled the tribes to navigate public systems, claim government benefits, and advocate for their rights.

Health and Nutrition Initiatives

Malnutrition and anaemia were widespread among the *Paliyar* and *Puliyar* communities due to limited medical access. PEAK began addressing these issues through weekly medical assistance in each village. Monthly blood tests and the distribution of nutritional medicines improved overall health standards. Additionally, biannual medical camps conducted in collaboration with major hospitals ensured that those in need of advanced care were identified and supported.

Special focus was given to children, pregnant women, and the elderly — groups most affected by nutritional deficiencies. Daily distribution of sprouted pulses and small grain porridges significantly improved their health conditions. The organization also conducted awareness programs on hygiene and sanitation, emphasizing cleanliness as a key component of well-being. Home gardens were introduced to promote organic vegetable cultivation, and waste segregation practices were implemented with the provision of garbage bins.

Housing and Infrastructure Development

Over the years, PEAK has also made remarkable strides in improving housing and community infrastructure. In 2012, the organization built eight houses in Kumbaraiyur; in 2018, eighteen more in Malayakad; followed by twenty houses in Kadukuthadi and twenty-four for renovation works. The establishment of community centres in J. J. Nagar (2024) and Gandhipuram (2025) further strengthened their social and communal bonding. Several new homes were built in partnership with government welfare schemes, reflecting PEAK's ongoing commitment to improving living conditions.

Women Empowerment and Livelihood Support

Women have been the central focus of PEAK's empowerment efforts. The formation of seven women's Self-Help Groups has fostered independence, cooperation, and entrepreneurship among tribal women. To support sustainable livelihoods, PEAK provides interest-free loans for self-employment, encouraging families to pursue income-generating activities and achieve financial independence.

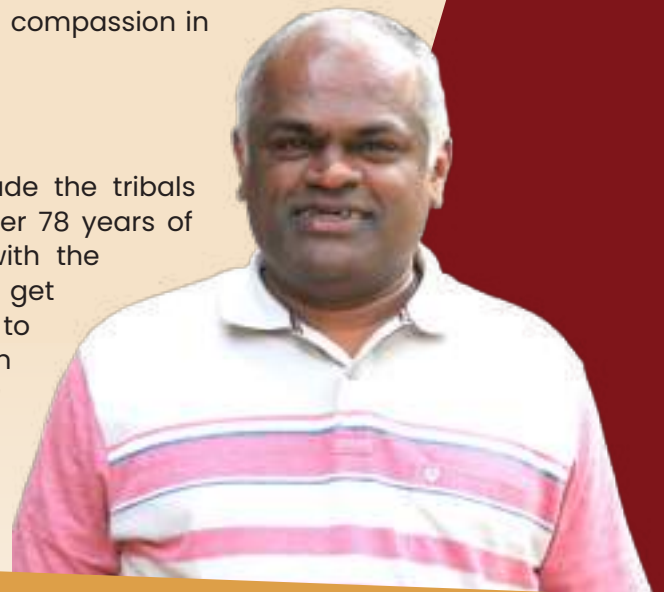
Towards Self-Reliance and Political Participation

One of the most inspiring outcomes of PEAK's continuous involvement is the rising political awareness among the tribal population. Many now actively participate in village panchayat meetings, articulate their needs, and even hold leadership positions in local governance. They have begun acquiring essential legal documents, purchasing land, and submitting petitions for basic amenities; tangible signs of empowerment and inclusion.

Through its comprehensive efforts, PEAK has not only uplifted hundreds of tribal families but has also ignited a spirit of self-reliance, dignity, and progress among the *Paliyar* and *Puliyar* communities. Its journey stands as a testament to the transformative power of education, awareness, and compassion in building a just and inclusive society.

Accompanying with the Tribal People

The economically and politically powerful people made the tribals landless and alienated them from their own lands. After 78 years of Independent India, tribal people in Kodaikanal live with the following questions and expectations. When will we get common toilets for villages? When will we get a road to reach the village? When will we get the land for cultivation and to build a house? When will we get a ration shop? When will we get a bus for transport? In their struggle for decent and dignified livelihood, PEAK is committed to accompany the Tribal and Dalit communities to get their basic rights and government welfare schemes and thus we shape the present for the future of the people in Kodai hills.



Chapter 16

Training the poor students through technical education



Implementing Institution:

St. Joseph's Technical Institute.

A short description of the project:

St. Joseph's Technical Institute, a unit of Kalangarai Social Animation Centre, is located in Prathabaramapuram village, Kilvelur Taluk, in Nagapattinam District, a coastal region of Tamil Nadu. Two institutions function within the same campus:

- i) St. Joseph's Community College and
- ii) Multi-Skill Technician Centre (MSTC)



St. Joseph's Community College (SJCC):

Kalangarai established the Community College in September 2005. The students who enrol in the college are generally high school or higher secondary graduates. As most of them come from marginalized communities, they often struggle to pay their college and hostel fees. For students who travel from distant areas, board and lodging facilities are provided at St. Joseph's Boys Hostel.



Multi-skill Technician Centre (MSTC):

In June 2024, the Jesuit Madurai Province permitted Kalangarai to establish the MSTC within the campus of St. Joseph's Technical Institute. The centre aims to upgrade the technical skills of students to international standards, thereby helping them secure employment abroad or in reputed companies across India.

This intensive 60-day residential program includes training in:

- i) Refrigeration and Air-conditioning,
- ii) Electricals,
- iii) Welding,
- iv) Wiring,
- v) Plumbing,
- vi) Fire-fighting systems,
- vii) Kitchen management, and
- viii) Soft skills such as computer literacy and spoken English.

Objectives of the project:

The primary objective of the project was to extend financial support to the hostel students of St. Joseph's Community College and the trainees of the MSTC who were unable to afford their institute and hostel fees.

Key Activities Carried out in the Academic Year 2024–2025:



Scholarships to the Hostellers of St. Joseph's Boys Hostel:

The Community College reopened in July 2024, and the academic year concluded in June 2025. A total of 55 students were enrolled during this period, of whom 25 resided at St. Joseph's Boys Hostel. Each hosteller paid Rs. 1,200 per month for board and lodging, amounting to Rs. 12,000 per year. Through the JRDS scholarship fund, financial assistance worth Rs. 195,000 was provided to all 25 hostellers.



Scholarships to MST Trainees:

The first MSTC batch began in June 2024, and by 15th August 2025, six batches had successfully completed the course, totalling 36 trainees. Most trainees came from marginalized communities and faced financial hardships in paying the course and hostel fee of Rs. 36,000. To help them, scholarships from the JRDS fund were granted to 22 trainees, covering both their course and hostel expenses.

The JRDS project has played a vital role in supporting underprivileged students and trainees, enabling them to pursue their education and technical training without financial burdens. These scholarships have significantly contributed to empowering marginalized youth by equipping them with practical skills that lead to employment opportunities both in India and abroad. We remain deeply grateful to JRDS and our donors for their continued generosity and trust in our mission.



Testimonies...

My name is Nishanth Anto. I completed my Industrial Training at Loyola Technical Institute, Madurai. After finishing two years of my technical studies, I worked in Coimbatore for a year. However, my income was very meagre, and I struggled to manage food and accommodation. A close relative encouraged me to join the two-month intensive Multi-Skill Technician course at St. Joseph's Technical Institute, Nagapattinam. I enrolled in the first batch in June 2024. After completing the course, I secured a job as a technician at a star hotel in Chennai, where I worked for nine months. Later, I attended an online interview conducted by the Millenni Hotel, Dubai. I joined that hotel in June 2025 and now earn Rs. 51,000 per month. I am deeply grateful to all the trainers at St. Joseph's Technical Institute and to the generous benefactors who helped me become who I am today.

Mr. Nishanth Anto



I, Leo Michael, completed my Diploma in Electronics and Communication Engineering in 2017. Afterward, I worked in a restaurant for a year with a very low salary. Although I was regular in my work, I was eventually asked to leave, even after receiving a certificate of experience. At that point, my life became miserable. During this difficult time, I learned about the MST Centre at Nagapattinam. I joined the course and completed it within two months. The program helped me acquire several skills, including basic English communication. During the training, the MST Director arranged online interviews for the trainees. At the end of the course, I was selected to work as a technician at Radisson Blu Hotel, a five-star hotel in Chennai. I am highly satisfied with the training I received at St. Joseph's MST Centre, and I sincerely thank the fathers and staff who supported me throughout.

Mr. Leo Michael

I am J. Prakash. After completing my 12th standard, I worked as an untrained electrician and earned a very low salary due to my lack of professional skills. When I heard about the MST course offered by St. Joseph's Technical Institute at Nagapattinam, I enrolled in the two-month intensive training. The staff trained me well, and by the end of the program, I was confident in my abilities. Soon after, I was interviewed by Residency Tower, a star hotel in Chennai, and successfully secured a job. I am sincerely thankful to St. Joseph's Technical Institute for this opportunity and to all the dedicated teachers who supported me.

Mr. J. Prakash



Our Gratitude to...

We express our sincere gratitude to Jesuit Research and Development Society (JRDS) – JCSA for supporting this project.

Chapter 17

Summer camps for children of widowed women in Nagapattinam



Implementing Institution:

'KALANGARAI Social Animation Centre', located in Nagapattinam, Tamil Nadu organized the summer camp. The Boys' camp started on 1st May and ended on 6th May, and the Girls' camp began on 7th May and finished on 12th May, 2025. A total of 87 children, i.e. 46 boys and 41 girls, participated in the camps.

Objectives:

The overarching aim of the six-day residential camps was not just to inform but to transform the young participants into socially conscious, confident, and compassionate individuals ready to contribute to their communities. The camps provided a nurturing space for learning, expression, reflection, and transformation. The overall theme of the camps was *"Thedal – Kandathum Katrathum"*, which means "Search – Discover – Learn".

Activities Carried Out:



Social Awareness:

Sessions were conducted on social analysis, Dr. B. R. Ambedkar (the principal architect of the Indian Constitution), and E. V. R. Periyar (a social reformer and staunch advocate for justice and equality). Discussions also covered gender justice, marginalization, and women's struggles.

Half a day was devoted to sessions on the Indian Constitution and citizens' rights, followed by a workshop on mock assembly elections and a children's parliament.



Drug Awareness & Prevention:

One of the biggest threats facing Indian youth today is alcohol and drug abuse. Our experience shows that a considerable number of widows' sons fall into drinking habits.

To address this, sessions were held to create awareness about the harmful effects of alcohol and drugs. During the girls' camp, a public rally was organized where students carried placards promoting awareness against drug use.



Health, Wellness & Self-Discipline:

Physical and mental health are essential for the holistic development of students. Each day began with physical exercise, yoga, meditation, and manual work. Additional sessions were offered on personal hygiene, mental well-being, and emotional regulation, particularly for the girl participants.



Skills for Life:

Students were encouraged to develop skills in study methods, career guidance, and digital literacy. Sessions also included a few themes on time management, online safety, and personal growth.



Creativity & Cultural Expression:

Creativity is vital for today's youth as it enhances self-expression, confidence, critical thinking, and innovation. Every evening after supper, students presented skits, music, dance, drawing, and storytelling. These performances not only celebrated creativity but also built teamwork and collaboration among the students.



Empathy & Emotional Growth:

One of our major concerns is that many children struggle to understand and respect their widowed mothers. Some even express resentment or speak ill of them when Kalangarai invites them for any training. To address this, half a day was dedicated to exploring the plight of widows. The session deeply moved the students — many boys were seen crying, realizing their past disrespectful behaviour towards their widowed mothers. That same evening, several students called their mothers to apologize for their misdeeds and to express love and appreciation.



Creativity is vital for today's youth as it enhances self-expression, confidence, critical thinking, and innovation.





Relationship between Widowed / Abandoned Women and Kalangarai:

Kalangarai presented its ongoing programs and initiatives for the empowerment of widowed and abandoned women. Many children publicly acknowledged the positive transformation in their mothers — how they had gained self-confidence, courage, and dignity through the interventions of Kalangarai.

Impacts of the Camps:

- The students expressed deep gratitude to Kalangarai for organizing the camp and regretted that some of their friends missed this valuable experience.
- Despite coming from two different districts (Nagapattinam and Mayiladuthurai), the participants developed strong bonds of friendship.
- The girl participants expressed happiness for learning about the POCSO Act and other laws protecting children from abuse.
- Many mothers reported to Kalangarai staff that their children had asked forgiveness for not understanding or respecting them and had become more responsible and obedient.
- Several students began supporting their mothers' small enterprises, such as helping in shops or accompanying them for business activities.
- One joyful mother shared that after the camp, her son encouraged her to wear a nice saree to attend a social function — a gesture of renewed affection and dignity.

Conclusion:

The Summer Camps of 2025 were significant milestones in building a socially conscious, emotionally mature, and physically healthy community of children.

Through the combination of education, creativity, and activism, the students gained a deeper understanding of their world and their role in shaping a just and humane society.

Kalangarai remains committed to nurturing the next generation of leaders, critical thinkers, and advocates for social and environmental justice.



Our Sincere Gratitude to...

We are grateful to **Mr. John Eugene Edward** and all the dedicated members of the **BAY AREA TAMIL CATHOLIC FELLOWSHIP** for their generous support in providing dining facilities to our home.



Chapter 18

Training Students to Be Agents of Environmental Protection and Organic Farming



Implementing Institution:

The Society of St Francis Xavier, Fr Dr S. IGNACIMUTHU, S.J. Ph. D, D.Sc. FNAAS, FRES, Director, Xavier Research Foundation, St Xavier's College, Palayamkottai – 627 002, Tamil Nadu, India.

Project start date and end date:

Start date: 01.12.2022

End date: 30.11.2025

Objectives of the project:

Goal:



To promote environmental awareness and organic farming activities among students in Tirunelveli district.

Objective(s):



To give awareness and training to students about the present environmental and agricultural problems.



To motivate them to become agents of environmental protection and organic farming by getting involved in regular environmental and organic farming activities like planting, saplings, preparing natural manure, maintaining gardens, etc.



To train students in preparation and use of nursery saplings, biopesticide and Vermicompost and give in-house experience.



To form environment clubs and organic farming clubs in their institutions.

Key Activities Carried Out

- During this academic year, our team conducted a series of *environmental awareness programs* in local schools. The sessions focused on topics such as **environmental protection, biodiversity conservation, natural farming, and pollution control**. Interactive presentations and visual materials were used to explain the importance of protecting forests, wildlife, and natural resources. Students were educated on waste segregation, tree plantation, and renewable energy sources. Demonstrations were given on vermin composting, organic fertilizer preparation, and natural pest control. The program also included activities such as quiz competitions, essay writing, and drawing contests on environmental themes. Over **8,500 students** from various schools actively participated. The initiative created strong awareness among young learners about sustainable living and the importance of protecting our planet.
- Several schools appreciated the program for its practical impact on students' behavior. Many students began adopting eco-friendly habits such as reducing plastic use, planting trees, and maintaining cleanliness in their surroundings. Teachers reported that environmental topics discussed during the program became part of classroom activities and student projects. In many schools, students initiated a "*Green Club*" to continue awareness efforts and planted over **100 saplings** in their campus. Parents also expressed that their children became more conscious about saving water and electricity at home. A few participants even shared their experiences highlighting how the sessions inspired them to take environmental responsibility seriously. These stories reflect the positive transformation achieved through consistent awareness and motivation.

Testimonies...

I really enjoyed the awareness program—it helped me understand how to protect our environment in simple ways.

Ms. Priya R. (Government Hr. Sec. School, Tenkasi)

The session on pollution and natural farming was very interesting. Now I've started planting trees at home!

Mr. Karthik M. (St Mariers Hr. Sec. School, Snakaran Kovil)

This program taught me how small actions like not using plastic can make a big difference to nature.

Ms. Sneha S. (Amali Hr. Sec. School, Ambasamuthram)

I liked the activities and pictures shown during the talk. I learned how to keep my surroundings clean and green.

Mr. Arun K. (Government Hr. Sec. School, Uvari)



Our Sincere Gratitude to...

The project is supported by the generosity of our friends from **Stiftung Jesuiten Weltweit**, Switzerland.

Chapter 19

Renovation of Wenisch Boys' Home



Implementing Institution:

Institute of the Heart of Jesus, Wenisch Boys' Home

Short Description of the Project:

The Boys' Home, started by Fr. Turlan S.J., at St. Mary's School Campus, Madurai in 1918, was shifted to IHJ, Dindigul in 1964 and Fr. Paul Wenisch, S.J., became its director. The poor boys, especially the orphans and semi-orphans in and around Madurai & Dindigul were admitted and supported with necessities. The glorious service continues till this day. The boys stay on the first floor of the IHJ building and get educated in our Jesuit School. Some of them who are formed in this institute have felt the call of God and joined different religious congregations. So far, nearly 550 candidates have gone through this institute and currently there are 24 boys being trained in this building, presently known as **Wenisch Boys' Home**.

Fr. Paul Wenisch S.J., a French Missionary, put up the building in 1963 with the generous contribution by Toulouse Province. **PWPN, EYM and Thoothan** offices are placed at this building and their leaflets, posters, and videos to promote catholic devotion are produced here. Storing, designing, packaging, and forwarding of the books, magazines, leaflets, etc. are done in this building. So far, there has not been any major repair or maintenance work in this building. Hence, it was a genuine and felt need that the building is renovated to increase the durability and utility of the building to continue the mission of the Institute of the Heart of Jesus.

Goals Achieved by the Project:

It was the felt need to renovate the Wenisch Apostolic Home Building, where besides the apostolic home, a few other activities are carried out that are aligned with our printing ministry, and the offices of PWPN, EYM and Thoothan, our monthly magazine. The renovation of the building was carried out successfully and the building looks very new and it will surely be in good condition for many more years to come. After the renovation, the building looks more elegant with the new facilities.

“

**No vocation is born of itself or lives for itself.
A vocation flows from the heart of God and
blossoms in the good soil of faithful people.**

”



Our Sincere Gratitude to...

We are grateful to Father General and FACSI for the generous contribution for making this project a reality.

Chapter 20

A few glimpses through the lens...

Inauguration of the Province Development Office:

The Province Development Office was inaugurated on 30 May 2024 at Maduralaya, the Jesuit Madurai Provincialate. The office was blessed by Fr. M. Devadoss, S.J., and opened by CA. Dr. Pannai M. Karthikeyan in the presence of Fr. Thomas Amirtham, S.J., the Provincial and Fr. Maria Joseph, S.J., the Province Treasurer.



Visit of Ms. Janina Emmenegger from *Jesuitenweltweit*, Switzerland:

Ms. Janina Emmenegger visited the Jesuit Madurai Province from 29 September to 6 October 2024. During her visit, she was taken to all our social action centres where the projects are carried out. She had a rich experience of encountering the people whom we support in our target villages in and through their generosity. She interacted with our beneficiaries. It was a time of strengthening our friendship.



Visit of Mr. Andre and Mrs. Helen from Nandri – Hilfe für Südindien, Switzerland:

Mr. Andre and Mrs. Helen Straessle visited our Province on 28 January 2025. They visited our AMUTHU centre at Oddanchatram and inaugurated a multi-purpose hall constructed with their support.



Visit of Mr. Marshal Pandya and Mrs. Lenka Pandya from Cesta Domov, Slovakia:

Mrs. Lenka Pandya and Mr. Marshal Pandya along with their children visited our Province from 20-22 February 2025 to explore the possible ways of supporting our deserving children through their organization.



Contact:

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To share the joy of giving

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Name of the Bank : Axis Bank Ltd.,
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IFSC Code : UTIB0003963
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80G of the Income Tax Act,1961)



Dearest Lord,

*Teach me to be generous,
To serve you as you deserve,
To give and not to count the cost,
To fight and not to heed the wounds,
To toil and not to seek for rest,
To labor and not to look for any reward,
Save that of knowing that I do your holy will.*

– St. Ignatius of Loyola

